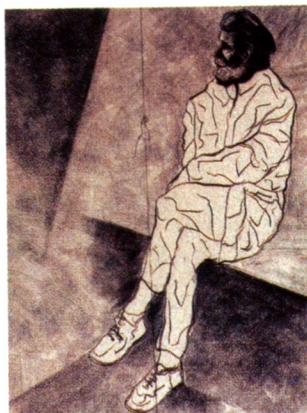


exhibition **Expressive Style**

CHENNAI Yusuf Arakkal's frigid lines in stark black and white capture the solitude in his exhibition titled 'A Journey of a Solitary Line'. Each drawing is private and contemplative.

Arakkal began his journey as a rebellious child. He was fascinated by people he met during his travels around the world. What emerged was a collection of travel drawings, done in Israel,

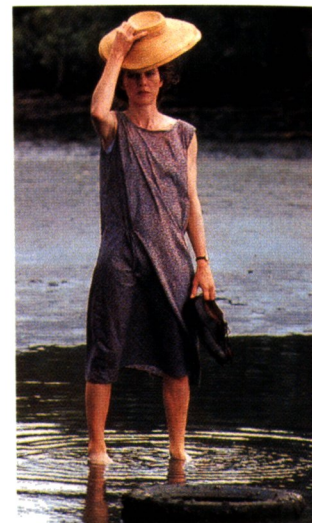


A Rome-inspired drawing Russia, London and Italy, in which he has depicted the details of each country through clothes and postures. His sojourn in Israel

brought him in contact with "some incredible faces", but interestingly, the faces in the series are kept in a shadow. "I did these sketches from memory—there is more depth of feeling in them than there would have been if I had done portraits," he says, adding, "the type of solitude varies from country to country. In Turkey, the body language was much more relaxed, while in London the impression was of icy aloofness even in a crowd." Till March 10. At the Vinnyasa Gallery.

by Minu Ittype

film festival **Viva Australia**



Swimming Upstream is the true story of a swimmer

There's more to Australia than the kangaroo, the kookaburra and the Opera House. In March, Delhi, Hyderabad and Bangalore will host a series of films courtesy the Australian Department of Foreign Affairs and Trade and the Australian Film Commission. This is the fourth time the festival, called 'Australian Vision', has made it to India. It features a wide variety of films with multiple themes.

From a 1969 mafia drama, a comedy about a migrant mother and daughter living in a dusty Australian town, to a young girl's journey through Australian ski fields, the festival promises to evoke Australia in all its stunning landscape and creativity. The opening film is *Jindabyne*, based on Raymond Carver's short story *So Much Water So Close To Home*. Also featured is *Ned Kelly*, a tale of a gangster, and *Swimming Upstream*—an inspirational story. The festival will be on in Delhi from March 6-9, in Hyderabad from March 8-10 and in Bangalore from March 14-17.

by Bushra Ahmed



recommendations **A Musical Feast**

CHENNAI In a city dominated by Carnatic tradition, the three-day festival, Gharana, is an opportunity for music lovers to connect with the rich resonance of Hindustani music. The festival will see performances by Rajeev Taranath (sarod), Shruti Sadolikar (vocal) and Nityanand Haldipur (flute). Listeners can also look forward to an elaborate *alaap* or a *jod* or *jhala*. From March 7. At Museum Theatre. by S. Sahaya Ranjit

DELHI The Airtel Shalom Peace Concert is an annual celebration that brings together various artistes from different genres. Starting March 6, the three-day festival will cast an array of bands. It will begin with a performance



Jalebee Cartel

Overload from Pakistan by the Israeli group J Viewz and Overload from Pakistan. On day two, Vishal Vaid from the US and Prem Joshua and band will perform before the audience. The group Jalebee Cartel will feature its own compositions with a funky, international sound that's unlikely to be recognised as Indian. On the third day, Karsh Kale will fuse Indian classical and electronica to create a contemporary note. The finale features Midival Punditz, who also marry traditional music with western electronic music. At Sixmonthstory.